Prop-Firm Strategy: Playbook, Results, Rules and Replication Guide

Research notes, updated November 2026. Repository: **EnderWiggin2027/Quantconnect-Data**, branch **claude/festive-dirac-jgT5l**. Everything here is a **simulation** of futures prop-firm accounts on real ES data (2022-2026). The numbers are model outputs, not guarantees.

1. Bottom line

- The trading rules have **no edge of their own**. On real ES the gross result is about 0 points per trade, and a normal-account backtest lost money. **All the modeled profit comes from the prop-firm payoff**: a failed evaluation costs only its fee, while payouts are real cash.
- **The final plan uses three firms and two account types.** The 150K accounts use a "one-trade" playbook that is only valid where the drawdown is checked at the **end of the day** (not intraday). The 25K accounts use the earlier "loop" playbook.
- **Day 1:** Lucid 3 x 150K Flex + 2 x 25K Pro, and FundedNext 2 x 25K Pro. **When cash reaches $30,000:** FundedNext 3 x 150K Flex, and MyFundedFutures 3 x 150K + 2 x 25K. That is 15 accounts at full build-out, the maximum of 5 per firm.
- **Median result at about 1 tick of slippage**, starting with $12,000, after each firm's real commissions: **+$40k at 2 months** (2.0% chance of being down), **+$303k at 6 months**, **+$697k at 12 months**. At 3 ticks: +$29k / +$241k / +$564k.
- This is a high-volume business: about 500 evaluations a year, about $94k of fees spent against about $790k of payouts received (medians, 1 tick).
- The biggest unknowns are **firm rules and enforcement** (a rule change, payout denial, or ban removes the edge), **your real slippage**, and **end-of-day versus intraday breach**. If a 150K account liquidates intraday, the one-trade playbook roughly breaks even and must not be used.

Read before trading. Confirm every rule in section 6 with each firm's current terms. Confirm that running the same strategy on many accounts is allowed. Never run this strategy with your own capital: without the prop payoff it loses money.

2. The easy playbook

2.1 What to buy

When	Lucid	FundedNext	MyFundedFutures
Day 1 (cost about $1,166)	3 x 150K Flex ($265.30 each) + 2 x 25K Pro, loss limit OFF ($100 each)	2 x 25K Pro ($85 each)	-
When cash reaches $30,000	-	add 3 x 150K Flex ($259.99 each)	add 3 x 150K ($334 each) + 2 x 25K ($98 each)
Always	Keep 5 slots full: when an account busts or closes, buy a new evaluation the next day	Same	Same

"Cash" means your starting $12,000 plus all payouts received minus all fees paid.

2.2 Daily routine (all times ET)

Time	What to do
09:30	Note the opening price of ES (the first 1-minute bar's open).
10:00	**Set the day's direction.** ES above the 09:30 open: everyone goes LONG today. Below: everyone goes SHORT. Equal: no trading. Then open the 150K one-trade positions and start the 25K "A" loops.
11:00	Start the 25K "B" loops.
15:30	No new 25K loop entries after this time.
15:59	Flatten everything that is still open, on every account.

2.3 Account cards

150K one-trade playbook. At 10:00, buy (or sell) at market at max size in the day's direction. Place a **limit** take-profit X points away. **No stop.** If the target fills, you are done for the day. If not, close at market at 15:59.

Firm, 150K account	Evaluation: size / target	Funded: size / target	Pass rate (model)	Avg paid per funded account
Lucid 150K Flex	10 minis / +7 points	10 minis / +3 points	56%	about $4,930
FundedNext 150K Flex	8 minis / +8 points	8 minis / +3 points	53%	about $5,770
MyFundedFutures 150K	9 minis / +11 points	9 minis / +4 points	58% (min 2 days)	about $5,810 (33% get any payout)

Why no stop: with end-of-day breach and a $4,000-4,500 drawdown, an intraday swing does not end the account. Only the close counts. Bold play (max size, one shot) passes more often than any cautious sizing tested.

25K loop playbook (Lucid 25K Pro, FundedNext 25K Pro, MFF 25K: two accounts each, called A and B). From the start time, enter at market in the day's direction with a stop and a target. When the trade exits, re-enter on the next bar. Stop for the day once that day's closed profit reaches +6 points (per contract), or after 8 trades.

Account	Evaluation: start / stop / target / day cap / size	Funded: start / stop / target / day cap / size	After first payout
A	10:00 / 8 / 8 / +6 pts / 20 micros	10:00 / 12 / 8 / +6 pts / 18 micros	Halve to 9 micros
B	11:00 / 8 / 8 / +6 pts / 20 micros	11:00 / 12 / 8 / +6 pts / 18 micros	Halve to 9 micros

2.4 Events

Event	Action
Evaluation passes	Switch that account to its funded card the next day.
Account busts (closes at or below the floor)	Buy a new evaluation for that slot the next day (only if cash covers the fee).
Payout becomes allowed	Request it immediately, every time. Payouts refill cash and fund new evaluations.

Event	Action
Funded account hits its payout limit (Lucid and FN 150K: 5 payouts)	It closes. Buy a new evaluation for the slot.
Cash reaches $30,000	Buy the FundedNext 150Ks and the MFF 150Ks + 25Ks (section 2.1).

2.5 Golden rules

- Every account trades the **same direction**. Never hold opposite positions across accounts (all firms ban hedging).
- Never use the no-stop 150K playbook on an account that liquidates **intraday**.
- Stay inside each firm's max size and its news rules. Be flat by the firm's cutoff (for example, Lucid at 4:45pm).
- Do not add accounts early, size up after wins, or skip the direction rule. Every such change was tested and made results worse.

3. Expected results (final plan, real ES 2022-2026)

Each row shows medians of 10,000 simulated paths with a $12,000 start. "Spent" is evaluation fees paid. "Payouts" is cash received after the profit split. "Net" is the change in cash. The 5th percentile is a bad 1-in-20 outcome.

Slippage	Horizon	Spent	Payouts	Net (median)	Net, 5th pct	P(loss)	Evals bought
1 tick	2 months	$12,241	$54,494	**+$40,244**	+$5,993	2.0%	71
1 tick	6 months	$44,966	$349,355	**+$303,369**	+$129,785	0.3%	244
1 tick	12 months	$93,687	$790,496	**+$696,534**	+$432,079	0.3%	503
3 ticks	2 months	$12,191	$43,482	+$29,041	+$2,530	3.5%	74
3 ticks	6 months	$47,430	$290,094	+$241,482	+$83,483	0.8%	266
3 ticks	12 months	$100,397	$665,164	+$563,604	+$321,504	0.7%	555

Medians do not add exactly (median spent + median net differs from median payouts). Commissions are per firm (section 6.2). Taxes, platform and data fees are **not** included. Reproduce with: python scripts/prop/run_final_plan.py (about 10 s).

3.1 How to read this

- The first two months carry almost all the risk: cash is thin, and only Lucid and the FundedNext 25Ks are running. Staging the FundedNext and MFF 150Ks until $30k keeps the 2-month loss chance at about 2-3.5%.
- Spending roughly equals or exceeds the starting bankroll in the first 2 months. Payouts are recycled into new evaluations; you never need more than the $12,000 at once in the model.
- Slippage matters more than commissions. Real per-firm commissions cost about 2-3% of profit; going from 1 to 3 ticks costs about 20%.
- Twelve-month figures assume the firms keep accepting about 500 evaluations and hundreds of payouts a year from one person. That is the least certain assumption in the whole study.

4. Why it works

4.1 The convex payoff

An evaluation is an option: the downside is the fee ($85-$334), and the upside is a funded account paying thousands. With zero-edge trades, the pass probability depends on the **shape** of the daily profit and loss relative to the target and the drawdown, not on prediction skill. Tests confirmed this: a random-direction version passed evaluations about as often as the momentum version. The 10:00 direction rule only helps in the funded phase.

4.2 Bold play on the 150Ks

For a fair game, the best way to reach a target before a floor is to bet big and as few times as possible ("bold play"). On a 150K with a $9,000 target, 10 minis x +7 points is $3,500 a day, so a pass needs about 3 good days, and the $4,500 end-of-day drawdown absorbs most losing days. Cushion-based (timid) sizing was tested and passed less often. In the funded phase the target drops to +3/+4 points, so payouts are collected before the account wanders down to the floor.

4.3 Why end-of-day breach is essential

With no stop, an open position can be thousands of dollars down at midday and still finish fine. If the firm liquidates at the intraday floor, those days become busts. Modeled with intraday liquidation, the 150K one-trade playbook was about break-even (EV of -$55 to +$25 per attempt), so it was rejected for that case. Lucid, FundedNext and MFF 150K were modeled as end-of-day breach. **Confirm this before trading.**

4.4 Why the 25Ks still loop

The 25K accounts cap size at 2 minis and have a tiny $1,000 drawdown, so bold play is impossible. The loop with a small daily profit cap creates many small winning days and passes the easy $1,250-$1,500 targets quickly. These accounts carry the early months while the 150Ks are being bought.

5. Exact mechanical rules

Instrument: ES and MES futures (1 point = $50 per mini, $5 per micro). Regular session 09:30-16:00 ET. Times are 1-minute bar **end** times.

5.1 Direction (all accounts)

- At the 10:00 bar close compare price with the 09:30 open (open of the first bar). Above: long only. Below: short only. Equal: no trading.

5.2 150K one-trade

- Entry: market at the 10:00 bar close, in the day's direction, at the card size.
- Exit: limit at entry +/- target points. No stop. If the target is not filled, exit at market at 15:59 (or 2 minutes before an early close).
- At most one trade per day. Simulation fills: the target fills when a later bar's high (long) or low (short) reaches it.

5.3 25K loop ("Portfolio B" slots 1 and 2)

- From the start time, enter at the bar close with stop S and target T. When a trade exits, re-enter on the next bar with the same S and T.
- Stop for the day at +cap points closed (per contract, gross) or after 8 trades. No entries after 15:30. Flatten at 15:59.
- If a bar touches both the stop and the target, the stop is assumed to fill first. If a bar opens beyond a level, the fill is at the open.
- Funded size halves after the account's first payout (18 to 9 micros). This was the one tuning that raised profit and cut risk.

5.4 Account management

- Up to 5 accounts per firm. Refill a slot the day after it busts or closes, if cash covers the fee. Request payouts the first day they are allowed.
- FundedNext and MFF 150K, plus MFF 25K, start only when cash is at least $30,000. After that they are refilled like the others.

6. Firm rules as modeled

"(A)" marks an **assumption** where the material provided did not state the rule. If any rule differs, edit scripts/prop/prop_sim.py and rerun.

6.1 150K accounts

Rule	Lucid 150K Flex	FundedNext 150K Flex	MyFundedFutures 150K
Price	$265.30	$259.99	$334
Target / drawdown	$9,000 / $4,500 end-of-day trailing	$8,000 / $4,000 end-of-day trailing	$9,000 / $4,500 end-of-day trailing
Breach	End of day only	End of day only (A)	End of day only (A)

Rule	Lucid 150K Flex	FundedNext 150K Flex	MyFundedFutures 150K
Eval consistency	40%: target = max($9,000, best day / 0.4)	40% (best day $3,200 at the base target)	50%: target = max($9,000, best day / 0.5)
Min eval days	-	3	2
Max size	10 minis	8 minis	9 minis
Funded floor lock	Locks at +$100 once balance reaches $154,600, or at first payout	Locks at +$100 once up $4,100, or at first payout	Locks at +$100 after first payout
Payout conditions	5 days of $250+ since last payout; cycle profit > 0	5 days of $250+; cycle profit at least $500	Every 10 funded trading days (about 14 calendar days) (A)
Payout amount	50% of profit, cap $3,000, min $500	50% of profit, cap $4,000	60% of profit (A), min $1,000
Split / payout limit	90% / closes after 5 payouts	95% / closes after 5 payouts	80% / no limit (A)

6.2 25K accounts

Rule	Lucid 25K Pro	FundedNext 25K Pro	MyFundedFutures 25K
Price	$100 (daily loss limit OFF)	$85	$98
Target / drawdown	$1,250 / $1,000 end-of-day	$1,500 / $1,000 end-of-day	$1,500 / $1,000 end-of-day
Eval consistency / min days	None	None	30% (target bump) / 4 days
Funded floor	Locks at +$100	Locks at +$100 (A)	Locks at +$100
Payout conditions	$250+ since last payout; best day at most 40% of cycle; $1,100 buffer	Every 3 trading days (A); best day at most 40%	Daily; $250+ net; $1,100 buffer
Payout amount	Profit - $1,100, cap $1,000 first, $1,500 later; min $500	50% of profit (A), cap $800, min $250	Profit - $1,100, min $500
Split	90%	90%	90%

6.3 Commissions (round trip, per contract)

Firm	ES mini	MES micro	Source
Lucid	$3.50	$1.00	$1.75 / $0.50 per side (user-provided)
FundedNext	$5.76	$1.74 (A)	$2.88 per side (user-provided)
MyFundedFutures	$4.68	$1.74	User-provided
Slippage (all)	1 or 3 ticks x $12.50 per mini-equivalent per trade		Model input

7. What was tested and rejected

Option	Why it was rejected
150K one-trade with **intraday** liquidation	Roughly break-even (EV of -$55 to +$25 per attempt). Midday swings bust accounts that would recover by the close.
Cushion / timid sizing on the 150Ks	Lower pass rate than bold play at max size.
Lucid 25K Pro with the daily loss limit ON ($84)	Loses: the $600 pause cuts the loop's recovery trades (12-month median about +$7.7k, 24% loss chance).
Lucid 50K Flex ($150)	Works, but the 2-month loss chance is about 18%. Replaced by the 150K Flex.
FundedNext 50K Flex ($140)	Works alone (about +$55k a year), but is weaker than the FN 25K Pro + 150K pair.
Apex 50K	$1,000 daily loss limit, safety-net payouts and a 50% consistency rule: lost money at every size tested.
Tradeify (all accounts)	Excluded by choice. The 25K v1 lost money; the v2 was weak.
Filters, other entries and exits, brute-force mixes	VIX, gap and opening-range filters; pullback, breakout, trailing and breakeven exits; 1,500 random portfolios. Improvements did not hold out of sample.
Adding all firms on day 1	More money at 12 months, but a 2-month loss chance of 8-19%. Staging at $30k is the better trade-off.

8. How the plan evolved

Before the 150K accounts, the best plan used only 25K accounts (5 per firm, all on the loop). Results on real ES, at Lucid-style $3.50 commissions:

Slippage	All-25K plan	2 months	6 months	12 months
1 tick	A: Lucid Pro + FN Pro day 1, MFF at $30k	+16,836 / -1,099 / 6.3%	+77,978 / +25,468 / 0.2%	+175,875 / +97,882 / 0.2%
1 tick	B: Lucid Pro day 1, FN Pro + MFF at $30k	+10,868 / -29 / 5.1%	+59,296 / +15,221 / 0.1%	+157,475 / +80,815 / 0.0%
3 ticks	A	+10,607 / -5,117 / 15.3%	+46,561 / +7,737 / 2.1%	+110,847 / +40,672 / 1.2%
3 ticks	B	+6,875 / -2,296 / 12.4%	+28,926 / +7,263 / 0.8%	+93,843 / +29,498 / 0.1%

Cells: median net / 5th percentile / chance of loss. Reproduce with python scripts/prop/run_25k_plans.py. Adding the end-of-day 150K accounts with the one-trade playbook raised the 12-month median about 4x (+$176k to +$697k) and cut the 2-month loss chance from 6.3% to 2.0%.

8.1 Multiple markets (synthetic test, still open)

Running accounts on independent synthetic markets cut early risk 3-10x (for example, the 1-month loss chance fell from 16% to 3% with 10 markets). Synthetic markets are perfectly independent, so this is an upper bound. The real test needs CL, GC, SI, HG and NG 1-minute data (multi_market_download.ipynb, split by year), with the playbooks rescaled to each market's volatility. Reproduce: run_25k_plans.py --multimarket.

9. Method

- **Data:** continuous front-month ES 1-minute RTH bars, Jan 2022 - Nov 2026 (data/ES_1m_RTH/ES_1m_RTH_2022-2026.csv.gz, from QuantConnect via ES_download.ipynb). Full days only (first bar 09:31, at least 300 bars): 1,199 days.
- **Tapes:** build_tape.py records each 25K preset's daily points and trade count. build_shapes.py does the same for the five 150K one-trade shapes. Day $ = 50 x size x points - trades x (commission + size x ticks x $12.50).
- **Monte Carlo:** 10,000 paths at seed 3. Each path draws trading days at random from the tape, and **all accounts trade the same drawn day**, so cross-account correlation is kept. The shared bankroll starts at $12,000. Horizons are 42, 126 and 252 trading days.
- **Every rule in section 6 is applied daily:** fees, end-of-day trailing floors and locks, consistency as a target bump, minimum days, payout conditions, caps, splits, payout limits and the $30k start trigger.
- **Anti-overfitting:** playbooks were selected on synthetic ES (seeds 1-3, scripts/synth_es.py: jump-diffusion + GARCH + regimes) or on older data, then judged on real ES. Searches that did not hold out of sample were dropped.
- **Known weaknesses:** 2022-2026 is a single, mostly rising period; the bootstrap ignores multi-day streaks; payouts and rebuys are instant; some firm rules are assumed (A).

10. Risks

- **Rules and enforcement:** the whole profit depends on the firms. Rule changes, payout reviews, or bans for running the same strategy across many accounts would end it.
- **Scale:** about 500 evaluations and hundreds of payouts a year may draw scrutiny. The 6- and 12-month numbers assume nothing changes.
- **No-stop exposure:** a 150K position at 10 minis can lose $5,000+ on a crash day. The firm absorbs it in the model, but a gap past the floor may still count.
- **Correlation:** all accounts trade one direction in one market, so bad days hit everything at once.
- **Slippage:** 3 ticks costs about 20% of profit. Measure it on a simulated account before going live.
- **Taxes and fees:** income tax on payouts, platform and data fees, and activation fees are not modeled.

11. Replication guide

Path	What it is
data/ES_1m_RTH/ES_1m_RTH_2022-2026.csv.gz	Real ES 1-minute RTH bars (input)
data/tapes/ES_tape_2022-2026.csv	25K loop tape (built automatically if missing)
data/tapes/ES_shapes_2022-2026.pkl	150K one-trade shape tape (built automatically if missing)
scripts/prop/presets.py, build_tape.py	25K loop presets and the tape builder
scripts/prop/build_shapes.py	150K one-trade shapes (targets 7, 8, 11, 3, 4 points)
scripts/prop/prop_sim.py	Monte Carlo of all firms (kinds l150, pro, fn150, fnpro, mff150, mff). Fees and rules live here.
scripts/prop/run_final_plan.py	Final plan: section 3 table, with per-firm commissions
scripts/prop/run_25k_plans.py	Earlier all-25K plans (section 8); --multimarket for the synthetic test
scripts/synth_es.py	Synthetic ES generator
docs/make_prop_pdf.py	Regenerates this PDF

```
git clone https://github.com/EnderWiggin2027/Quantconnect-Data && cd Quantconnect-Data
git checkout claude/festive-dirac-jgT5l
pip install numpy pandas reportlab
python scripts/prop/run_final_plan.py          # final plan, section 3 (about 10 s)
python scripts/prop/run_25k_plans.py           # earlier 25K plans, section 8 (about 20 s)
python docs/make_prop_pdf.py                   # rebuild this PDF
```

11.1 Prompt to give an AI assistant

```
Repository EnderWiggin2027/Quantconnect-Data, branch claude/festive-dirac-jgT5l, contains a prop-firm study.
Read docs/prop_firm_strategy.pdf and scripts/prop/.
1. Run python scripts/prop/run_final_plan.py and confirm the medians match section 3 of the PDF.
2. Direction: 10:00 ET close vs 09:30 open; all accounts trade that direction only.
   150K accounts: one market entry at 10:00, limit target, no stop, exit 15:59 (build_shapes.py).
   25K accounts: stop/target loop with a daily profit cap (presets.py, build_tape.py).
3. Firm rules are in prop_sim.py (function sim). Sizes and commissions are in run_final_plan.py.
4. To test a new firm, add a kind with its fee, target, drawdown, lock, consistency, payout rules, caps
   and split. Choose sizes on synthetic data first (scripts/synth_es.py), then run on real ES.
5. Report median, 5th percentile and P(loss) at 2, 6 and 12 months, at 1 and 3 ticks, plus fees spent
   and payouts received.
```

11.2 Key parameters

```
Monte Carlo: 10,000 paths, seed 3, bankroll $12,000, horizons 42/126/252 trading days
Fees: Lucid 150K $265.30, 25K Pro $100 | FN 150K $259.99, 25K Pro $85
      MFF 150K $334, 25K $98
Start trigger: FN 150K, MFF 150K and MFF 25K at cash >= $30,000
25K funded size: 1.8 minis, halved to 0.9 after the first payout. 150K funded size = eval size
```